CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Social Media Marketing Course Handbook

"Grow brands and businesses on the platforms people live on."



Brand Community & Social Strategy Track | 8 Weeks | All Levels Self-Paced Study Edition

Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame | chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com

Course Foreword



Billions of people spend hours a day on social media, and every business wants their attention. Social media marketing, growing and engaging an audience to build a brand and drive sales, is a skill in massive demand, whether you freelance for clients, run your own venture, or get hired in-house.

It is more than posting randomly and hoping. It is strategy: knowing your audience, planning content, creating value, engaging genuinely, and measuring results. This book teaches that professional approach, so you get real outcomes, not just likes.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will learn to choose platforms, plan a content strategy, create engaging posts, grow on Instagram, Facebook, TikTok and YouTube, read your analytics, and run paid ads.

Practice on a real account, your own or a business you help. Social media is learned by creating, posting and studying what actually happens.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 8-module workbook equips youth and emerging leaders with practical, ethical, income-ready skills. Complete every chapter drill in a dedicated workbook and reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Outcomes

01

Social media platforms overview: Each platform has its own audience and style.

02

Creating engaging content: Hook, value, and a clear reason to engage.

03

TikTok and YouTube basics: TikTok: authentic short video, huge discovery.

04

Paid advertising basics: A campaign is a focused push toward one goal.

Across 8 Weeks of structured practice, learners progress from core principles to real-world execution. Every module pairs concise frameworks with an immediate hands-on drill so knowledge turns into demonstrable competence.

Graduates finish with a tangible portfolio deliverable in Social Media Marketing, ready to serve clients, employers, ministries, and communities with excellence and integrity.

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01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 1: Social media platforms overview | Module 2: Content strategy and planning



1.1 Social media platforms overview

Each platform has its own audience, culture and content style, and you should meet people where they are rather than trying to be everywhere. Instagram is visual and lifestyle-driven; Facebook has broad reach and strong communities/groups; TikTok favours short, authentic, entertaining video; YouTube is for longer video and search; LinkedIn is professional. Knowing these differences shapes your whole strategy.

Rather than spreading thin, choose the one or two platforms where your target audience actually spends time and where your content type fits. A B2B service belongs on LinkedIn; a youth fashion brand thrives on Instagram and TikTok. Mastering the right platform beats being mediocre on all of them, focus is a strategy, not a limitation.

Real-World Example: A local restaurant wasted effort on LinkedIn before realising its customers were on Instagram and Facebook. Refocusing there, appetising photos and local community posts, finally brought real bookings. Right platform, right result.

Hands-On Practice: For a business you know, identify the one or two platforms where its target customers actually spend time, and why those fit best.

Core Takeaways: Each platform has its own audience and style. • Focus on where your audience actually is. • Mastering the right platform beats being everywhere.

1.2 Content strategy and planning

Random posting gets random results; strategy gets consistent growth. Start with clear goals (awareness, engagement, leads, sales) and a clear audience. Then define content 'pillars', a few recurring themes you'll be known for, so your feed has identity and you always know what to post. Planning ahead turns social media from stressful scrambling into a calm system.

Use a content calendar to plan posts in advance, balancing types (educational, entertaining, promotional, behind-the-scenes) so you're not always selling. Consistency is more important than perfection or frequency, a sustainable, regular rhythm builds an audience over time. A strategy on paper is what separates professional social media marketing from aimless posting.

01

Practitioner Case

A boutique defined three content pillars, new arrivals, styling tips, and customer features, and planned a month ahead. Posting became easy and consistent, the page gained a clear identity, and followers (and sales) grew steadily.

02

Action Drill

Define goals, audience, and three content pillars for a business. Plan one week of posts across those pillars in a simple calendar.

03

Key Standard

Strategy beats random posting. Define content pillars for identity and easy planning. Consistency matters more than frequency.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 3: Creating engaging content | Module 4: Instagram and Facebook marketing

2.1 Creating engaging content

Engaging content stops the scroll and makes people feel or act. The essentials: a strong hook (first line or first second), genuine value or entertainment, and a clear reason to engage (a question, a call to action). Visuals must be clean and eye-catching; video, especially short-form, currently gets the most reach on most platforms. Quality and relevance beat volume.

Know what your specific audience responds to and give them more of it. Mix formats (images, carousels, reels, stories, lives) to stay fresh, and always focus on the viewer, not just the brand, people engage with content that's about them, their problems and their aspirations. Authentic, useful, well-made content is what earns attention and grows a following.

Core Principle

Hook, value, and a clear reason to engage.

Field Case Study

A fitness coach's plain workout photos got little traction until she switched to short, energetic videos with a strong first line and a clear tip. Reach and engagement jumped, the format and hook made the same knowledge finally spread.

Applied Exercise

Create one piece of engaging content for a business: a strong hook, real value, clean visuals, and a call to engage. Post it and watch the response.

Mastery Check

Short video gets the most reach now. • Make content about the viewer, not just the brand.

2.2 Three-Step Execution Rhythm

Step 1

Prepare & Frame
Hook, value, and a clear reason to engage.

Practice Focus
Audit your current approach before acting.

Step 2

Execute Deliberately
Short video gets the most reach now.

Practice Focus
Focus on clarity, calm pace, and measurable value.

Step 3

Review & Refine
Make content about the viewer, not just the brand.

Practice Focus
Record outcomes and sharpen one habit per rep.

2.3 Instagram and Facebook marketing

Instagram is visual-first: use high-quality images and reels, a clear bio with a call to action, stories for daily connection, and relevant hashtags to be discovered. Consistency and a cohesive look build a strong brand presence. Reels are especially powerful for reaching new audiences beyond your current followers.

Facebook offers broad reach and powerful communities. Business pages, active participation in relevant Groups, and its events and marketplace features all help. Facebook and Instagram share an ad system (Meta Ads) with excellent targeting. For many local and consumer businesses, a strong presence across these two platforms covers most of their audience effectively.

01

Instagram: visuals, reels, stories, hashtags.

02

Facebook: pages, groups, events, broad reach.

03

They share a powerful ad system (Meta Ads).

2.4 Real-World Case & Lab Assignment

Practitioner Case Study

A local baker grew through Instagram reels of cakes being decorated (reaching new people) plus an active Facebook page and local group posts (reaching her community). Together they filled her order book without a shilling of ad spend at first.

Your Practical Assignment

Optimise an Instagram or Facebook business profile: clear bio, call to action, and a plan for one reel and one community/group post.

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Study Principle: "Instagram: visuals, reels, stories, hashtags. Consistent execution in small daily assignments builds authority that cannot be faked."



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 5: TikTok and YouTube basics | Module 6: Analytics and insights

3.1 TikTok and YouTube basics

TikTok rewards authentic, entertaining short videos and can give even small accounts huge reach through its powerful discovery algorithm. The keys: a scroll-stopping first second, trends and sounds, genuine (not overly polished) energy, and consistency. It's a remarkable free opportunity for brands and creators to reach new audiences fast.

YouTube is both a video platform and a search engine, ideal for longer, valuable content that people find via search for years. It builds deep trust and authority. Short-form (TikTok, Reels, Shorts) is best for fast reach and discovery; long-form (YouTube) is best for depth, trust and lasting searchable content. Used together, they cover both discovery and depth.



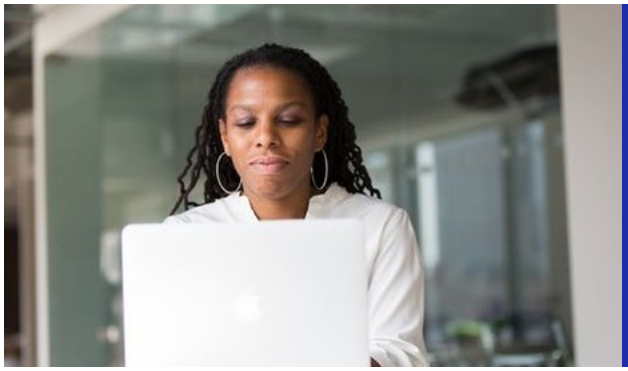
Case: A skincare brand posted quick TikToks that went semi-viral (reach) and detailed YouTube tutorials that ranked in search (trust and lasting traffic). New audiences discovered them on TikTok, then deepened trust on YouTube, and bought.

Action Drill: Plan one short-form video (hook + trend/value) for TikTok/Reels and one longer YouTube video idea (searchable, in-depth) for a business

3.2 Analytics and insights

Every platform gives you free analytics, use them. They reveal what's working: which posts get reach, saves, shares and engagement; when your audience is online; and who your followers actually are. This data turns guesswork into informed decisions, letting you double down on what resonates and drop what doesn't.

Look beyond vanity metrics (raw likes and follower counts) to what matters for the goal: engagement rate, saves and shares (signals of real value), profile clicks, and conversions (leads or sales). Review regularly, spot patterns, and adjust your strategy. The marketer who reads insights and adapts consistently outperforms the one who just keeps posting on instinct.



Case: A brand's analytics showed that its 'how-to' posts got far more saves and shares than its product posts. It made more how-to content, reach grew, and sales followed, the data revealed what the audience truly valued.

Action Drill: Open the analytics of any social account. Identify the top three posts by saves/shares/engagement and note what they have in common.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 7: Paid advertising basics | Module 8: Run a social media campaign

4.1 Paid advertising basics

Organic (free) reach is powerful but slow and increasingly limited; paid ads let you reach the right people quickly and at scale. Social ad platforms (especially Meta Ads for Facebook/Instagram) offer precise targeting by location, age, interests and behaviour, so even a small budget can reach exactly the right audience, far more efficiently than traditional advertising.

The basics of a good ad: a clear objective (reach, leads, or sales), a specific target audience, a strong creative (scroll-stopping visual and message), and a compelling offer. Start with a small budget, test different versions, and scale what works while cutting what doesn't. Skilled paid social is a highly valuable, in-demand service you can offer clients.

Field Example: A small online shop spent a modest daily budget on a Meta ad targeting nearby shoppers interested in its niche, using a short video and a discount offer. It brought a clear, trackable return, more sales than the ad cost, and she scaled it up. | Drill: Design one paid ad plan: objective, exact target audience, creative concept, offer, and a small starting budget. Note how you'd measure success.

4.2 Run a social media campaign (Capstone)

Your final project brings everything together: plan and run a real social media campaign for a business. Set the goal and audience, choose the platform(s), plan the content, decide whether to include paid ads, and define how you'll measure success. A campaign is a focused, coordinated effort over a set period toward one clear objective, not just ongoing posting.

Execute it, engage with the audience it attracts, track the results, and review what worked. Even a small real campaign teaches more than any theory and gives you a concrete result to show clients or employers. Social media marketing is a career-long learning field, keep creating, measuring and adapting, and your skills (and value) keep growing.

Competency Area	Capstone Standard	Starting	Target Mastery
1. Clarity & Preparation	Paid ads give fast, precise, scalable reach.	Needs Draft	Confident & Ready
2. Execution Quality	A campaign is a focused push toward one goal.	In Practice	Portfolio-Grade
3. Real-World Proof	Plan a full social campaign on one page: goal, audience, platform(s), content, ads (optional), and metrics. Run a small version if you can.	Planned	Completed & Reviewed
4. Consistency Habit	A real campaign proves a sellable skill.	Occasional	Weekly Discipline

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice Matrix

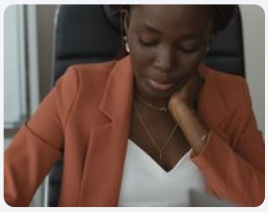
Use this checklist to track every hands-on assignment in Social Media Marketing from Module 1 to your final project:

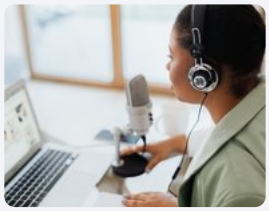
Module	Focus Topic	Core Deliverable & Principle
Module 01	Social media platforms overview	Each platform has its own audience and style.
Module 02	Content strategy and planning	Strategy beats random posting.
Module 03	Creating engaging content	Hook, value, and a clear reason to engage.
Module 04	Instagram and Facebook marketing	Instagram: visuals, reels, stories, hashtags.
Module 05	TikTok and YouTube basics	TikTok: authentic short video, huge discovery.
Module 06	Analytics and insights	Free analytics turn guessing into knowing.
Module 07	Paid advertising basics	Paid ads give fast, precise, scalable reach.
Module 08	Run a social media campaign	A campaign is a focused push toward one goal.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Reflections

"A local restaurant wasted effort on LinkedIn before realising its customers were on Instagram and Facebook. Refocusing there, appetising photos and local community posts, finally brought real bookings. Right platform, right result."

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Cohort Case Note | Module 01





"A learner ran a two-week launch campaign for a friend's new product: a content plan, a few reels, engagement replies, and a small ad. Tracked with a discount code, it drove real sales, proof of a genuine, sellable skill."

CHRISCO Digital Academy Capstone Highlight | Module 08

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Social Media Marketing is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 drills and document your baseline specimen in Social Media Marketing.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Plan a full social campaign on one page: goal, audience, platform(s), content, ads (optional), and metrics. Run a small version if you can.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

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Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

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Official Gmail Contacts
chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
shambetz@gmail.com

Official Course E-Book for Social Media Marketing (Brand Community & Social Strategy Track).
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For course guidance or mentorship, email chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com. CHRISCO Youth Aflame